

A LESSON IN POOR PLANNING

6. COACHING HUB, JAIPUR

LAUNCHED: 2023 (Congress)
COST: Rs 221 crore
STATUS: Mostly vacant, alternative use planned

Envisioned to benefit 70,000 students and earn Rs 450 crore revenue during the previous Congress regime, Jaipur's Coaching Hub has flopped—only 14 of 224 units sold, where just a few hundred students are enrolled. Curiously, the Rajasthan Housing Board bypassed its usual pre-booking model, rushing ahead without assured takers. Coaching institutes pushed back, citing steep prices and seeking concessions. Sharma now proposes setting up an IIT Jodhpur satellite campus and offering space to other national institutions. ■

ABANDONED ARENA

During her first tenure, it was Vasundhara Raje's dream to build an international-standard Organised Archery, Shooting & Equestrian Sports (OASES) Complex with a polo arena. Of the Rs 100 crore earmarked, Rs 80 crore was spent. In the end, only the shooting range became operational while the rest of the site stands abandoned—its stables unused and infrastructure rusting. Neither Gehlot in his two terms nor Raje herself in her second stint took it forward. "We have not thought about it for many years now," admits JDA commissioner Anandhi. A symbol of grand vision left to decay. ■

7. OASES COMPLEX, JAIPUR

LAUNCHED: 2007 (BJP)
COST: Rs 80 crore
STATUS: Only shooting range operational, remaining project abandoned



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



FOSSILISED VISION

Proposed in 2009, the greenfield refinery has seen two foundation stones—first by the Congress in 2013 and then by the BJP as a petrochemical complex in 2018. Initially pegged at Rs 37,000 crore, the cost has now doubled amid delays and a prolonged equity tussle with HPCL, the project partner. With the global shift toward electric vehicles, experts are questioning the long-term viability of such fossil-fuel infrastructure. Uncertainty also looms over the actual crude and gas reserves available in Barmer and nearby fields to sustain the plant. "We hope to complete it by year-end," claims T. Ravikant, principal secretary, mines & petroleum. Whether it will power the future, or become a relic of the past, remains to be seen. ■

8. BARMER REFINERY AND PETROCHEMICAL COMPLEX, PACHPADRA

LAUNCHED: 2013 (Congress)
COST: Rs 37,000 crore initally, escalated to Rs 74,000 crore
STATUS: Incomplete